

Parag Gandhi

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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE SUMMARY

Dynamic and results-driven Project Manager & IT leader with over 18 years of progressive experience managing complex technology initiatives, driving enterprise solutions, and leading global teams. Proven track record of delivering high-impact IT projects with exceptional organizational, leadership, analytical, and technical expertise. Highly adaptable, self-motivated team player with a strong ability to align technology strategies with business goals while ensuring operational excellence and continuous improvement.

AREAS OF EXPERTISE

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| ♦ Infrastructure Technologies | ♦ Project Management | ♦ Application Integration |
| ♦ Agile Methodology | ♦ Cloud Platforms | ♦ Database Management |
| ♦ Systems Design/Implementation | ♦ Disaster Recovery & BCP | ♦ Incident Management |
| ♦ Strategic & Tactical Planning | ♦ Storage technologies | ♦ Service Delivery Mgmt. |

PROFESSIONAL SYNOPSIS

- Accomplished IT leader with over 18 years of experience delivering enterprise technology solutions across cloud, on-premises, and hybrid platforms, with expertise spanning financial services, infrastructure, and security
- Proven success partnering with C-level executives and business unit leaders to drive high-impact projects, implement global IT governance frameworks, and standardize operations across geographically diverse teams.
- Expert in managing full lifecycle enterprise IT implementations, from project initiation and planning to execution, monitoring, and delivery, ensuring alignment with strategic business objectives.
- Skilled in translating complex business requirements into scalable technical solutions, while continuously evaluating project risks, timelines, and costs to ensure optimal outcomes.
- Delivered comprehensive cost-benefit and ROI analyses that informed multi-million-dollar IT investment decisions, enabling data-driven leadership approvals.
- Built and led global IT teams, fostering collaboration, accountability, and consistent delivery excellence while exceeding performance and customer satisfaction targets.
- Spearheaded the design and deployment of global service delivery models for enterprise support teams, driving process efficiency and operational maturity.
- Successfully navigated and resolved project challenges, including resource constraints, scope adjustments, competing business needs, and cross-functional conflicts.
- Adept at evaluating vendor solutions, negotiating contracts, and designing custom technology integrations for complex business environments.
- Recognized for adaptive leadership in highly dynamic global IT environments, effectively managing both technical complexity and stakeholder expectations across multiple regions.
- Established strong collaborative relationships across IT, business units, engineering, and vendor ecosystems to accelerate productivity, reduce costs, and improve service quality.
- Deep expertise in release management processes, delivering predictable product deployments while optimizing support costs and minimizing post-release incidents.
- Strong knowledge of Financial Industry business and compliance requirements for IT Governance

KEY PROJECTS

- Lead Unix Engineering & Implementation Projects within the Next Gen Data Center initiative
- Design & implement clustering solutions to migrating to SAP HANA from mainframe environment
- Managed several Application & Database Migration Projects for Property Casualty Division
- Establishing a global Service Delivery & Management matrix organization for Unix Operations
- Implementing IT Governance for the Diversified Application Farms initiative

WORK EXPERIENCE

Mizuho (New York, NY)

May 2022 – April 2025

Project Manager, Risk Management

- Oversaw multiple infrastructure and application integration projects across enterprise platforms, ensuring alignment with strategic objectives and regulatory compliance within financial services
- Designed and maintained detailed Excel-based tracking tools to monitor headcount allocation, project hours, and resource utilization across global technology teams, enhancing visibility and accountability.
- Implemented a tagging system within Excel and Jira Board to map individual team members to specific projects and tasks, streamlining resource planning and budget forecasting.
- Coordinated with senior leadership and cross-functional teams to align IT delivery with business priorities, leveraging Agile and Waterfall methodologies for structured execution.
- Managed project lifecycles end-to-end, including planning, scope definition, budgeting, and risk assessment using tools such as Microsoft Project and ServiceNow.
- Facilitated project governance reporting by preparing weekly status dashboards and project health summaries, integrating data from ServiceNow and Excel to track milestones, risks, and resource constraints.
- Supported PMO with documentation of RACI matrices, capacity planning, and continuous process improvements to minimize downtime and increase efficiency across global teams.

Systemart (Parsippany, NJ)

July 2020 - September 2021

Project Manager, Business Development

- Partnered with new clients to define software development project requirements, aligning deliverables with business objectives and stakeholder expectations.
- Developed comprehensive project plans and timelines for client e-commerce platforms focused on financial product suites, ensuring alignment with scope, resources, and budget
- Facilitated stakeholder meetings and cross-functional coordination sessions to track progress, address risks, and maintain consistent project momentum.
- Conducted business needs analysis to identify opportunities for new service offerings, contributing to business development growth and client satisfaction.
- Delivered actionable reporting and status updates to leadership, ensuring full transparency and proactive resolution of potential project roadblocks.

Tapestry (Carlstadt, NJ)

May 2018 – July 2020

Project Manager, Security Program

- Led the development and execution of the InfoSec Group Mandatory Security Training Program, ensuring 100% compliance with corporate cybersecurity policies and regulatory requirements for both employees and contractors.
- Collaborated directly with the CISO and senior leadership to track progress, resolve escalations, and drive timely completion of mandatory training across multiple business units.
- Designed and maintained detailed compliance dashboards and visual reports (bar/pie charts) to communicate weekly status updates to executive stakeholders.
- Successfully achieved a 90% training compliance rate within the targeted 8-week program window, exceeding program goals and enhancing overall organizational security posture.

AIG (Livingston, NJ)

Jan 2004 - May 2017

Project Manager / Global Team Lead-Unix

- Worked on Complex as well as simple Projects for Migration of systems running from couple of millions to 10 million. Legacy Servers migrated to newer hardware or newer type of OSes.

- Managing large Datacenters running around 4000+ Unix Instance in Virtual or bare Metal Environment.
- Worked on all aspects of IT project governance, assessment, management and control. This built the ability to gather and define requirements; build a project plan; identifying resource needs
- Established Best practices for Operations excellence & Service delivery using ITIL guidelines, Process Improvements, Business Development for continuous support.
- Defined Number of Projects and provided Guidelines to Reduce Application Downtime and Reduce Repetitiveness of issue. This Proactive Approach helped Organization Big way and made Client achieve Higher Uptime on their Application.
- RACI Matrix used for Work Load Analysis or Conflict management on working on Complex projects
- Reviewed Build Process & Defined Build Check List to ensure that the server builds are done accurately and help troubleshoot issues in conjunction with Architect and Application Development teams.
- Provided effective and transparent project communication plan built with all Stakeholders including diverse work force and Global team members.
- Assisted in strategic direction for developing enterprise project plans specifying goals, strategy, staffing, scheduling, identification of risk, contingency plan and allocation of resources.
- Spearheaded Project on to Provide data protection, Recovery and Business Continuity; test and validate disaster recovery and business continuity methods in UNIX environment.
- Worked with PMO for Standardized Project Mgmt methods and decision making for complex projects.
- Worked with business sponsors and partners in designing, defining, planning and implementing technology solutions to meet business needs and specifications. Next gen Data Center Migration are best example for the same
- Experience in Team Management, Recruitment, conflict resolution, Policy design & Administration and Training & development. Ability to work in stressed environment and in time-scales to meet deadlines whilst maintaining quality.

TECH TOOLS & TECHNIQUES

Operating Systems	Red hat RHEL, SLES, Solaris, AIX
Clustering Technologies:	Veritas Clusters with CVM/CFS, ASM Cluster, Sun Cluster, Oracle RAC
Storage Management:	EMC Clarion, Symmetrix DMX, Vmax, Netapp, MPXIO, NFS
Virtualization:	Solaris Containers/Domains/LDOMS/Zones, VMWare, VMs, LPAR
Networking:	TCP/IP. UDP/Multicast, DNS, DHCP, IPSec, EDMZ, NAT, Vlan
Project Management:	Initiation / Planning/ Executing/ Control & Monitoring/ Closing. Cost Benefit Techniques like IRR/BCR/NPV. Critical Path Technique with Pert/CPM. RACi Matrix, SWOT Analysis, Scrum, Kanban, User Stories, Jira Board, Scrum Ceremonies, Risk appetite Analysis
Application Software:	Microsoft Project, Word, Excel, PowerPoint' Jira,
Project Methodologies:	Waterfall, Agile
Service Management Tools	Service Now, Remedy, CMDB, Cognos, SharePoint

PROFESSIONAL TRAINING

- DevOps Training
- AWS Sys Ops Administrator Associates Certification Training
- Project Management Professional Training / PMI Agile Methodology (PMI-ACP) Training

EDUCATION

B.E (Electronics Engineering) from Mumbai University